

3.3 Techniques to save and export visual identity and digital graphics

Save and export

- ☐ Proprietary format master files
- ☐ Repurpose and export in appropriate file formats

To include:

- Saving of files for visual identity and digital graphics as high resolution, proprietary format, master files as an archive for further edits
- Repurposing and exporting of visual identity and digital graphics in file formats and image properties which meet client requirements

Marking criteria

[Section 6.4](#) provides full information on how to mark the NEA units and apply the marking criteria. The marking criteria descriptor words are further explained in [Appendix B](#).

The tables below contain the marking criteria for the tasks for this unit. If a student's work does not meet any Mark Band 1 (MB1) criteria for the task, you must award zero marks for that task.

Unit R094 – Topic Area 1: Develop visual identity		
Unit R094 – Topic Area 2: Plan digital graphics for products		
MB1: 1–2 marks	MB2: 3–4 marks	MB3: 5–6 marks
Design concept for the visual identity is limited in its suitability for the client.	Design concept for the visual identity is adequate in its suitability for the client.	Design concept for the visual identity is fully suitable for the client.
MB1: 1–3 marks	MB2: 4–6 marks	MB3: 7–8 marks
Justification shows limited understanding of the extent to which the visual identity is fit for purpose.	Justification shows sound understanding of the extent to which the visual identity is fit for purpose.	Justification shows comprehensive understanding of the extent to which the visual identity is fit for purpose.
MB1: 1–2 marks	MB2: 3–4 marks	MB3: 5–6 marks
Produces basic planning documentation for the digital graphic product.	Produces adequate planning documentation for the digital graphic product.	Produces detailed planning documentation for the digital graphic product.

MB1: 1–2 marks	MB2: 3–4 marks	MB3: 5–6 marks
Use of technical skills to create the visual identity is limited in its effectiveness. Properties and format(s) of the visual identity are limited in appropriateness.	Use of technical skills to create the visual identity is adequate in its effectiveness. Properties and format(s) of the visual identity are adequate in appropriateness.	Use of technical skills to create the visual identity is effective. Properties and format(s) of the visual identity are clearly appropriate.
MB1: 1–2 marks	MB2: 3–4 marks	MB3: 5–6 marks
Few assets are prepared for use in the digital graphic. Use of technical skills to prepare assets is limited in its effectiveness.	Some assets are prepared for use in the digital graphic. Use of technical skills to prepare assets is partly effective.	All assets are prepared for use in the digital graphic. Use of technical skills to prepare assets is effective.
MB1: 1–4 marks	MB2: 5–8 marks	MB3: 9–12 marks
Use of tools and techniques to create the digital graphic products is limited in its effectiveness. Design concepts and layout conventions are applied in a limited way to the digital graphic products. The final digital graphic products meet the client's requirements in a limited way.	Use of tools and techniques to create the digital graphic products is partly effective. Design concepts and layout conventions are applied adequately to the digital graphic products. The final digital graphic products adequately meet the client's requirements.	Use of tools and techniques to create the digital graphic products is effective. Design concepts and layout conventions are applied effectively to the digital graphic products. Final digital graphic products fully meet the client's requirements.
MB1: 1–2 marks	MB2: 3–4 marks	MB3: 5–6 marks
Properties and format(s) of the final digital graphic products are limited in their appropriateness.	Properties and format(s) of the final digital graphic products are adequate in their appropriateness.	Properties and format(s) of the final digital graphic products are clearly appropriate.

Task 1

Strand 1a

A simple logo for the visual identity could be credited in Mark Band (MB)1. To achieve the higher mark bands, a more complex visual identity, incorporating suitable component features would be needed. This should be clearly appropriate for an intended audience/consumer and the nature of the client's product or service. Evidence of students' development of ideas can contribute to the marks, but the final concept must be clearly shown for MB3.

Strand 1b

The assessment is based on students' understanding of the extent to which the visual identity is fit for purpose. Statements that it meets the client's needs may be credited in MB1, whereas justifications of 'how' and 'why' are needed for the upper mark bands. To achieve MB3, the understanding would need to cover both the client and target audience/consumer. Note that this task is analytical/evaluative in nature.

When designing the visual identity and justifying their design choices, students need to make decisions independently. Although it is to be expected that different students may make similar decisions and develop similar ideas, it would be highly unusual for all students in a cohort to have identical work.

Strand 1c

Two main items of evidence contribute to the marking descriptors. These cover both what the intended graphic will look like and the details of any assets to be used. Both of these would be needed to consider achievement in MB3. A simple layout diagram would be appropriate for MB1. For the upper mark bands, this should be clear and detailed for use by the client or graphic designer. To record the details of assets, students may choose the format of the information themselves or use the asset table template on our secure website Teach Cambridge. More comprehensive details including permissions would be needed for the upper mark bands.

Students must not be directed to complete specific planning tasks but may be referred to the teaching and learning content for the unit. When designing their digital graphic product, students need to make decisions independently. Although it is to be expected that different students may make similar decisions and develop similar ideas, it would be highly unusual for all students in a cohort to have identical work.

Task 2

Strand 2a

There are two parts to this first strand. The first covers the creation of the visual identity while the second the requirement to save it in a suitable format. Technical skills are evidenced in the resulting quality of their use/application when creating the visual identity. This is a qualitative assessment. Areas to consider would be precision, accuracy, and overall effectiveness in the creation of the visual identity.

For the upper mark bands, the image properties and file format of the saved/exported visual identity should be suitable for further use in graphic design products. A combination of unsuitable properties and file format(s) may be credited within MB1 whereas both the image properties and choice of file format(s) for the visual identity would need to be appropriate for MB3.

Strand 2b

The first part of this strand, covering the preparation of assets, is assessed quantitatively. This should be clearly and explicitly evidenced as a preliminary activity before the creation of the actual digital graphic. If the preparation of assets is only implied in the final graphic, then MB1 would be appropriate. For MB3, all of the assets to be used in the digital graphic should be prepared at a suitable resolution.

The second part is about the use of technical skills to prepare the assets and the assessment is qualitative in nature. The ability to apply knowledge and understanding of the technical compatibility of the assets is a key determinant for the higher mark bands. Ensuring the dimensions, resolution and file format are suitable would be one way to meet this requirement. This should be supported by explicit evidence for the upper mark bands. If the evidence is only implied, then MB1 is appropriate.

Strand 2c

The first part of this strand assesses students' use of the tools and techniques found within image editing software applications to create the digital graphic. It is the degree to which students are effective in the use of the tools and techniques that is assessed at this stage, rather than the overall quality of the finished graphic. For the upper mark bands, students must evidence their skills in applying tools and techniques identified in the teaching content. Although Microsoft Office based applications are not disallowed, this is likely to constrain the opportunity for achievement to MB1 on the basis that many of the specified tools and techniques are not available.

The second descriptor assesses the overall look and feel of the finished graphic. It also assesses the application of design concepts and the layout conventions of graphic design. The placement and inclusion of the visual identity contributes towards this criterion. For the upper mark band this should effectively apply design concepts and layout conventions in order to be visually appealing and engaging for the viewer.

The third descriptor assesses how effectively the digital graphic meets the client's requirements. For the upper mark bands, the digital graphic would need to demonstrate a synergy or connection between what was wanted, the style of the visual identity and the content/layout of the finished graphic.

When creating their digital graphic product, students must make decisions independently. They must apply what they have learnt and not be led through a process to create a digital graphic product. Students must not be directed to use particular software or software tools and/or techniques.

Strand 2d

This strand is about saving and exporting the finished digital graphic in the two formats required by the parameters of the scenario. The image properties and file format contribute towards this and would need to be correct in both graphic files for the upper mark band.

When exporting their graphic, students need to independently decide on suitable electronic formats and properties.

Best fit assessment should be applied by taking both versions of the digital graphic into account. If one of these was clearly inappropriate, then best fit would place the achievement in MB2 at best.

Topic Area		Topic Area	
1	Develop visual identity	2	Factors influencing product design
2	Plan digital graphics for products	2	Factors influencing product design
		3	Pre-production planning
		4	Distribution considerations
3	Create visual identity and digital graphics	3	Pre-production planning
		4	Distribution considerations

More information about synoptic assessment within this qualification can be found in [section 5.2 Synoptic assessment](#).